

Ross lay on the couch, drank cold coffee, looked at his phone.⁶²² He drove down to Downing, loaded in drums, set up in the living room, had a slightly awkward rehearsal with Dulaney/Hannah, packed up, had tearful discussions, eventually went to bed.

vii.iv

He woke, feeling fragile, made coffees, had his plans to move a piano with Kevin cancelled. Hannah suggested he hang out with friends but eventually realized she'd rather blow off work, so they grabbed swim shorts from Meyers, Chipotle, Starbucks, drove to the Laurel River trailhead.

They parked, walked for a while, found Liz & friends, ate, swam, walked back to the car, started up the mountain, pulled to the side of the road, picked berries, continued on, stopped at a BBQ joint, ate a bit, took some to go, drove to Downing. Hannah napped and Ross emailed Morgan's Comics about a job opening.

At six, they drove to the Tunnel Road Ingles, then Liz's, where they each ate two hot dogs, checked out art projects around the house, packed a table into the Space Bug, drove to Downing, hung next door. Hannah sewed up one of Suli's toys, had a fashion show with Kathryn. Ross and Tim played chess.

Hannah and Ross went back next door, cuddled in the middle room, went to sleep.

vii.v

Ross woke from intense dreams about a freakishly powerful/mysterious teacher at a boarding school, made coffees while Hannah cooked pancakes. He slowly packed up the last of his drums, sat on the couch looking at his phone until Hannah asked, "Are you stuck?"

"I'm playing Wordle..."

He was indeed stuck. He went into the kitchen, asked if she needed help with anything. She said it would be better if he left, as he is the one who knows about time, and she has a lot to do, and his presence is too calming. He scarfed two pancakes, drove up to Meyers, heard from Stephen about how many trash bags of dead flies he had gathered in the basement, sat at the computer, wrote in his journal.¹¹²¹

Ross took a shower/shaved, lay in bed a while, got dressed, drove to Downing, put monitors, mic stand, guitar, Fishman into the Camry, drove to the Brew Pump. Ross got gas/hope waters while Hannah went across the street for rosemary chicken salad. She was feeling anxious. They got coffee in Sylva, continued to exit 74, realized they actually wanted 64, parked next to Kevin, were soon joined by Cliff/Jackson, carpooled out to Jim & Hal's compound in Stacoah.

They loaded in, set up, checked sounds, took turns playing music/eating until about 8:30, had a great time, drove back east to Downing, took just the guitar inside, went to sleep.

vii.vi

Ross's alarm went off at 6:30. He went into Hannah's room, gently checked to see if she had set one as well. She said she had for 6:45, so he went back to the middle room, got cuddles, hopped in the Camry, went to Starbucks, drove to Advance, went inside,

ate breakfast, watched the start of the British F1, played music, took naps, got back in the car.

Hannah drove to exit 125 for Starbucks, gas, then on to Asheville, listening to *Here Comes the Sun*, *Money*, *Schism*, *Eulogy*, *Live & Learn*, *In the End*, *Killing in the Name Of*, *Two Steps From Hell*. They loaded things from the Camry into Downing, kissed goodbye. Ross drove up to Meyers, thinking his break might have been long enough.⁶²⁴

Kamaka ran UBRs with LTD.⁷⁵²

Ross looked at Instagram.⁸²⁹

Tokup ran BRD with Pughouse, winning nothing.¹⁰⁰⁹

vii.vii

Ross typed on his device:

I woke from many senseless dreams and the reality of Stephen blasting movies in the basement + garbage truck chaos. I charged my phone, put on shorts/hat/flops, put my cup/wallet/phone into the Host Defense bag, walked slowly to Battle Cat, drank a double espresso + some lime bubbles.

I played Wordle (STILT in five,) looked at the Bot for the first time, shared my score with Bamboo Forest/family, walked to the end of Haywood, down the hill, across the bridge while thinking about the Beatles. I went around the traffic circle, sat at the bus stop, typed.¹¹⁵²

I stood up, walked to the Greagle thinking about the time a lady almost hit me in that intersection and how I thought I would always be prepared for that kind of situation. Well, a white work van came even closer; I had to run and do a spin to avoid being hit by a couple inches. He turned left onto Clingman and I'm unsure if he ever saw me. I sat down on the nearest set of steps to write and let the adrenaline surge through.¹²⁰¹

I walked up the hill, sat at the next bus stop, had a text from Hannah, "Good morning sweet pea! Hope your day is good"

I said, "Well I narrowly avoided getting run over by a work truck in the crosswalk at the grey eagle just now, like had to run and do a spin maneuver. He turned left and kept going, not sure he ever saw me

But yes, it has been good and I hope yours is too" ¹²¹¹

I turned right at Hilliard, crossed into the monstrosity parking lot, went onto Sneaky South Ann, up the hill behind Bee Thai, across French Broad, into downtown, passed over Biltmore, went through Pack Square, turned right at College, got into the shade of the bank, saw I had another text from Hannah, sat at the bus stop.

"I hope you are okay sweet pea! I am glad you are safe," she said.

I said, "Yeah just a lil rush of adrenaline/anger. I'm arriving at the bank now and I love you so much" ¹²⁴⁰

I went into the bank, deposited \$250 from the Stacoah gig, walked west on College, turned right at Rankin, sat on the sidewalk for a moment texting Hannah, went into High Five, ordered a drip, talked with the baristas and how drip needs a more hip name, walked to the park, texted with Hannah about her friend that had been hit after her CD release at the greagle, got Cliff's number, said,

"Yo Cliff, it's Ross! Thanks again for having us the other day. I've been thinking about how fun that gig was and figured I would snag your number from Hannah in case you ever needed any drumming. Your tunes are great and I would love to play on them if you ever need"

He said, "Heck yeah bud! Glad yall had a good time. I do wanna get that stuff figured out for live band." ¹¹²

I settled up with Dave, paid a week of rent, walked to Malaprops, looked for a journal, walked to the library, which was closed. I cut across to Battery Park, the indoor restroom, took a seat. ¹⁴⁵

Ross walked out of downtown, sat at the Clingman bus stop, did a chess puzzle, went across the bridge to the next stop, did another puzzle, walked up the hill. It started to rain. He tried to wait it out at Taco Billy, but, once the weather app finally updated, he summoned an Uber, rode to Meyers, got debriefed by Stephen, sat at the computer, wrote,³²⁸ made his bed, cooked noodles,³⁵¹ laid in bed, cleaned his room, heard from Stephen that Tony had possibly been shitting in the sink,⁴⁴⁶ talked to Hannah, took a bath,⁵⁴⁵ updated his website, made a cup of coffee.⁶²⁴

Ross walked to Ingles, bought grapes, pizza, hop water, went down to Downing, looked at his phone on the couch while Hannah fluttered about, made pizza, ate while watching Throw Down, made love, went to sleep.

vii.viii

Ross woke to Hannah's kitchen alarm, made coffees, ate grapes, walked with Hannah to Bad Manners, where he ordered a drip, then to Meyers, sat on the swing, scared the bird, kissed Hannah goodbye, went inside, put hop waters in the fridge, turned on the coffee warmer,⁸⁴² looked at his phone, took the most amazing nap,¹²²⁹ looked at his phone, made a sandwich, ate in the kitchen, got rundown of Stephen's stressors.¹⁵³

Ross was very pleased to do nothing with the rest of his day. He made noodles, listened to a playlist Wyndham had sent, organized his books, drank hop water, sent Erica pictures of her debit cards, talked to Hannah after class, tidied the iMac desk, went to sleep when it was well and truly dark.

VII.IX

I woke at seven, felt achey from doing nothing all day. Haden was banging around, gathering belongings. I sat up, closed my eyes, laid back down. She left and I immediately heard Stephen clanking around.

I typed up the end of my previous entry, played Wordle (NOVEL in five,) packed my scratch journal, On Quality, two pens, wallet, phone, went into the kitchen, borrowed a splash of coffee, heard about Stephen vomiting from cleaning chemicals, grabbed a hop water, left the house.

The birb was standing on the ground. I congratulated her on her hatching, which I may not yet have written about. I walked up to the Freemason lodge, sat, finished my coffee, switched to hope water, walked to Battle Cat, ordered a double espresso, sat on the porch, edited four pages, wrote,¹¹¹² read a chapter of On Quality,¹¹⁴³ talked to Hannah on the phone.¹¹⁵⁰

she said she was running behind, so I walked to Cooperative, ordered a drip and a draft bubbly water. I think the water was free, which actually makes the \$3.75 drip seem reasonable.¹²⁰³ I read another chapter, heard from Hannah, correctly solved five chess puzzles.¹²³¹

Ross got a text from Hannah saying she'd arrived, walked across the street to Taco Billy. Hannah pointed out that there were 3D printers in the space next door. Ross spun around his hat, peered inside. A tall fellow opened the door and invited them inside to his studio where he had been printing magnetic topographical maps. They talked for a while, parted ways.

Ross & Hannah went into Taco Billy, ordered four tacos, sat out back, ate, chatted, listened to Miley/Taytay. Ross walked alongside Hannah as she walked her bike up the hill. They wished each other good gigs/broken legs as she peddled off. He went to Ingles, bought grapes/floss, walked to Meyers, put

things away, hung up his bag, wrote,²³⁶ laid in bed looking at his phone, put some gig clothes in the Camry.⁵³⁴

Ross wrote in his scratch journal: *I got in the car, drove west on 40, took exit 64, arrived at the Town Pump, loaded in my throne, put it in a cozy corner of the stage. I laid out the rug, set up hardware/drums, hugged Terri, who agreed it was a little ridiculous if it was indeed my first time there. I walked around the block to the Grange, ordered a lil cheeseburger w/ tots—they were all out of hot dogs—and a Coke, sat at a wet table, wrote,⁶³⁵ ate while listening to Ozzy Osbourne trivia.*⁶⁴⁸

When the trivia host announced it was time for a bio break, Ross approached him and said, "Only MMO players say bio break," and the host said, "Ah yes, many years on World of Craft." Ross walked back to the Tavern, ordered an Athletica, sat on the back deck, decided he wanted his book, walked inside but saw that it was raining out front. He waited for that, grabbed his book, read maybe a page, talked to a french girl while Wyndham, Charlie, Kevin loaded in, set up, checked sounds.

He stood outside with Kevin and Charlie, chatted a bit, went inside, played two hours of bar music. During the third-to-last song, Cripple Creek, after all the parts of the song had been played and everyone had taken a solo, Ross played a clear drum fill to end the song, which apparently interrupted a solo Wyndham had intended to take. Wyndham said, "You're fired," to which the rest of the band laughed. He said, "Seriously, that's not cool. Don't ever do that. I end the tunes. Please don't do that again."

The group played two more songs, ending with Sultans of Swing. Wyndham was embarrassed, apologized, but Ross was unphased, more intrigued than anything. He also had an email from Morgan:

Ross,
Hello to you!

Our probation period is 3 months, after which everyone gets a personalized raise based on performance, experience, and compatibility with the Nerd Sanctuary's mission vision. Everyone starts at \$10/hr through probation (especially as the store is still recovering from Helene).

We are starting with having someone cover all Sundays &/or Mondays (as Matt & I only have our kids that full day, being blended families & Mondays are all day Dr appts for our newest addition) so we're seeking the person to start with these shifts and grow in hours as business improves throughout the season.

If that sounds like the environment you'd like to work in, please, message back to set up an in-person meeting.

Warmest Regards,
Morgan

Ross packed up his drums, said goodbye to his friends, ordered a Heiny Zero from Zach, drove in the rain to Downing, where Hannah was already in bed. He changed out of his wet clothes and they talked a while about their gigs and job opportunities before going to sleep.

vii.x

Ross was tired when Hannah got up. She suggested Taco Billy for breakfast and he groaned a little. She decided she would just drive to Hendersonville and he faced a bit of decision paralysis. He wanted to walk downtown to deposit his gig cash but didn't have his bag or cup.

Ross got dressed, kissed Hannah goodbye, got in the Camry, drove to the Smokey Park SECU, went into Ingles, started to look around for lunch things but realized he would end up spending a lot of money. He ordered a tall Sumatra, drove to Goodwill, but they didn't open until 10AM. He drove to Brew Pump,

bought a case of hop water, drove slowly to Meyers, put away his things.¹⁰⁰³

Ross relaxed, read, made split-pea noodle mush in the wok, took a heavy nap, woke up to texts including one from Hannah that said she and Ryan were at Odd's. He walked up, ordered a coffee, felt the vibes shift into absurdity. He drove Hannah to Baby Bull, where they had a nice dinner, then Lowe's, where they bought a paving slab for the cats and some toilet paper.

They drove to Ingles, bought coffee + ice cream, then down to Downing, where they watched an episode of Throw Down and went to bed.

vii.xi

Hannah's alarm went off and she hit the kettle, went back to bed. Ross got up, made a coffee, sat on the couch, cuddled, made another coffee while Hannah was in the shower. He watched her attach her bike rack with worry, got in the car, rode to Meyers, kissed her goodbye, put his coffee on the warmer, laid in bed.⁹³⁵

Kamaka made a piece of mooncloth.¹⁰²²

I got in the Camry, drove to Trammell, found the key, let Chuck out. She was very excited then immediately anxious about something. It took me a while to realize it was the thunderstorm, that she only felt safe with me in the bedroom and herself under the bed.

We stayed like that basically all night aside from dinnertime. I talked to Hannah a couple times, ate lots of snacks, designed the C-60 on KLE, eventually decided to redesign it to be a sub-60 form factor. I visualized the specifics of the case for a long time and eventually decided I wanted to do no baselayer, 3mm wall, 3D-printed hairband gasket shelf w/ magnets + 2mm lip, then a topshell.

The only remaining mystery is whether I should integrate the MCU. My original thought was to save

costs by not, but there's barely enough room for it in the current layercase, and this would be 3MM shorter.

VII.XII

I slept til the monsters demanded food, fed them, ate fwuit, went back to bed, woke with a stiff back, made espresso, went out on the porch.¹⁰⁵⁴

I drank that, did the dishes cleaned the litter, talked to Hannah, figured out how to dispense hot water from the espresso machine, made an Americano, did kung-fu w/ Chuck on the porch, packed my bag, drove downtown.

I parked next to Charlie the Human's car, went inside the LaZoom Room, chatted w/ Jenn, said what's-up to Matt, loaded drums onto the bus, greeted Charlie/Dulci, told her about Wyndham's explosion. We drove to Highland with Fletcher hosting, rehearsed, rode to New Belgium, jammed, rode to Wedge, rehearsed, rode downtown.

I was tired, packed up drums, said goodbye to the friends, went to the co-op, bought noodles, ginger ale, a plum, sat in the shade, ate, talked to Hannah. I drove to Meyers, talked to her again, went inside, got bugged by Stephen, got into Hannah's car, rode to Ace, got a nut for her mic stand.

We went down to Downing, sat on the couch, looked at our phones, talked about keyboards, read from The Artist's Way, cuddled, went to bed.

VII.XIII

Woke at 7:30 from having clearly slept hard, looked at my phone for an hour, heard Hannah stirring, cuddled, made coffees, drank on the couch while looking at my phone. We drove to the newly reopened High Five by the river, drank, ate, sat in/on the tarp/hammock while working on projects.¹¹⁵⁷

We moved to a table, talked about pontooning, drove to Chipotle, picked up food, went to her house, parted ways. I talked with Kathryn in the yard about the video debating where the downbeat is in *Roll Out*. I walked to Ingles, bought grapes, continued to Meyers, set the iMac up at the living room table, created the PCB for shortcut while eating a burrito, took some breaks, eventually had switches, diodes, mcu pins, routing, reset button, graphics, text, mounting house and an error-free DRC.

I turned on the light in my bedroom, set up the MacBook air, transcribed entries, wrote.⁹³⁹

VII.XIV

I woke feeling very tired, sore even, eventually got up, ate some grapes, lay back down, mustered strength, left the house, walked to the bus stop just before the bridge.¹⁰¹⁰ I guess I also played Wordle (UNDID in four.) I do not understand why I feel so sore.

I walked across the bridge, sat at the next stop, did a chess puzzle, went up the hill, through downtown to the bank, deposited \$40 in cash (LaZoom tips + Kevsitting,) and a \$125 check from the bus, walked to High Five, ordered a drip/Spindrift, sat in the window for five secs, walked to the park, sat under a tree, checked my finances and my calendar, wrote.¹¹³⁹ ~~I can't be~~ I'm so excited to have three gigs coming up this weekend.

Ross gathered his things, got up, walked down the stairs. A friendly black dude asked him what he was doing over there. He said, "Checking my finances and my calendar, doing some thinking and some not thinking." They talked about jobs, drums, apartments, PAs. Ross learned his name was Crow, walked back west, stopping spontaneously into the WALK, where he ordered lasagna soup, which wasn't nearly noodly enough.

He drank some Coke, paid, walked to Meyers, laid on the bed, moved to the computer, transcribed, wrote.²³⁰ He ordered the Shortcut PCB, started on the case design, laid in bed, drove to Mizu, ate beef udon, drove to the Hot Spot, bought a coffee, drove to Waterford Court. He chatted with Alex, greeted Charlie, got the rundown on taking care of Ophelia/Merlin, drank an NA beer, toured the garden, got back in the car.

He talked to Hannah on the phone, drove to Meyers, did some more case design, walked down to Downing, cuddled on the couch with Hannah. They decided to take a walk, headed for the Hop, went to West Village Market instead, but they were closed, so they went across the street to the Brew Pump, got some hop waters + Purple People Feeder, chatted with Nelia/Penny, walked down to Downing, ate, made love, went to bed.

vii.xv

Ross woke to Hannah's alarm, cuddled, made coffees, sat on the couch, watched videos including Bulgarian Womens Choir and the 2002 JHS show, walked to Ingles, bought peas/ramen/hope water, went to Bad Manners, ordered a drip, dripped his way to Meyers, ate grapes, finished the 2D portion of Shortcut case design.¹¹²⁵ He went into WoW, checked mail on all his toons, waved goodbye to Dookem accidentally, then everyone.¹¹⁴⁰

Ross went into OnShape, designed the Shortcut case as best he could, drove to Morgan's Comics, had a comfortable and exciting interview with Matt, Morgan, Bird, got in the car, called Hannah with no answer, drove to Meyers, made some peas/noodles, talked to Hannah, polished up the Shortcut case, took a bath, shaved, including mustache.⁸²⁰

Ross loaded his project into the Bambu Studio Slicer, found it was too large to be printed no matter how he sliced it, felt dejected, thought his clean-shaven was stupid, had a tinge of regret over

getting a job. Hannah called, invited herself over. They cuddled in the bed until Ross felt better and had an idea about how to continue his projects.¹⁰³⁸

vii.xvi

Ross woke, busted at Wordle (NERVY,) laid in bed for too long, made a coffee, his first good one in a while from the espresso machine, borrowed \$25 from Dave, went to UJ, ate a turkey pita w/ tots, no beverage, talked to Alisha, walked to Morgan's Comics, toured the facilities, fixed up the comic wall, looked at spreadsheets, stamped logos on bags, drank a Sunkist, swept, got the crash course on how to open/close.

He walked to Meyers, talked to Dustin/Amy, went in the house, drank a hop water, got in his tux, drove to LaZoom Room, walked to Wortham, chatted with Smitty/???, ate hour'dourves, drank drinks, listened to Elizabeth Corvi, a couple bankers, watched the season preview.

Ross kissed Hannah goodbye, drove to Trammell, got high, played *Only Takes a Minute*, *Birds of a Feather*, some new cover, *Time is Infinite* with Ryan, Dulci, Kevin (on keys/LH Moog,) chatted in the yard w/ Fwuit, grabbed some pretzel dogs, drove to Meyers, talked to Hannah on the phone, who said she was wanting to have more of an arist's life, went inside, opened a hop water, took off his tux, wrote.¹¹¹⁷

vii.xvii

Ross had a hard time waking up, made two coffees, drove to Downing, loaded in, set up, had a fulfilling rehearsal with Kevin, Dulaney, Hannah, packed up, loaded out, went to Taco Billy with Hannah, dropped her off at Downing, drove to Meyers, moved the glass desk over to the window, set the iMac on it, turned it on.²¹⁰

Ross did a 2D mockup of the third iteration of the Shortcut case, got dressed, made a coffee, drove to Zadie's, got a sour NA beer, chatted with Luke, greeted Ryan, sat up drums, ate a veggie bowl, checked sounds, played a fun set, took a break, played another fun set, broke down quickly to avoid incoming storms, talked to Hannah on the phone, drove to Meyers, lay in bed, looked at his phone.⁹²⁶

He did 2D case design, loaded it into OnShape, noted a couple desired changes, went to bed.

vii.xviii

Ross woke around 9, struggled with Wordle, made coffee, talked to Hannah, did case design, made another coffee, got lasercutting quotes from Ponoko, realized they offer 3D printing, got a quote on the original Shortcut case design, which was \$45 for the bottom layers as opposed to \$80.¹²⁵⁸

Ross did another iteration, 3DP with thicc walls, sent for quotes, drove to Baby Bull, was told to wait 20 minutes, ordered a burger/fries/Coke, drove to Downing, loaded Hannah things into the Camry, drove to Eda's Hideaway, loaded in, set up, greeted Hannah, Jackson, Kevin, checked sounds, played a fun set, took a long break, played a still-fun set to a less-full room, packed up, waited for Hannah to finish talking to friends, caravanned to Downing, lay on the couch, fell asleep.

vii.xix

Ross woke when Hannah came to check on him, cuddled, got a random call from Jeff Ratner, talked to him for 30 minutes, made coffee, ate pancakes with Hannah, drove to Meyers, caught up with Stephen, lay on the bed, fell asleep, got up, turned on the coffee maker, heated up some water.³³⁷

Ross made two coffees, got in the Camry, drove to Saluda, slowly loaded into the Purple Onion, set up around Kyle, ordered halibut/bork pelly special, ate

in the grotto, played a fun show with Dulci, Alyse, Kevin, Ryan, packed up, drank an Athletic, got back in the Camry, drove up 26, talking to Hannah, arrived at Meyers, took off his star blue button-up, lay on the bed, looked at his phone.¹¹³³

vii.xx

Ross woke at ten, talked to Hannah, made coffee, flopped around in bed, eventually flashed a Rebound w/ PiFrame, was baffled that it worked on the iMac but not Air.¹²⁶ He continued to rot as Hannah's day got delayed, eventually ordering a pizza.⁶⁰⁶

He ate, slowly realizing his pizza, despite having the correct vibes, was 4/6th incorrect toppings, called Hannah, walked to Ingles, bought grapes/hop water, continued down to Downing, saw a bear, sat on the couch, read some of Hannah's homework, watched an episode of pottery, had phone time, went to bed in the newly rearranged middle room.

VII.XXI

Woke to the sound of Hannah's alarms after dreams of touring 'Virginia Tech' in search of Adam Bolt, who had been appointed a designated entity by Donald Trump to provide an item that shortened a freshman quest. Maddy Schuler was there too.

I snuggled Hannah, made her a coffee, sat in the relocated blue chair, watched her stretch, used my laser vision to heal her. When she got in the shower, I made the middle bed, gathered belongings, ate some grapes, played Wordle (TIZZY in six,) hugged her goodbye, walked to Battle Cat, realizing I had forgotten my cup. I ordered an espresso/lime La Croix, drank on the porch, texted with Hannah.⁹⁵⁶

Ross walked to the bank, deposited \$270 in cash, paid one week of rent doubled back to High Five, ordered a double espresso, which came with some

fizzy water, drank in the window, paid car insurance, walked to Pritchard, called Jeff Ratner, chatted for 28 minutes, drank a Spindrift, walked to the Brew Pump, bought some hop water, went to Meyers, thinking about how he could possibly make a cheaper Shortcut case out of FR4/leather.¹⁵⁸

Ross wrote in his notebook: *I did some case brainstorming, (a minimal design the exact width of the PCB just barely fits on the A1 plate.) received my PCBs from UPS, opened them, added diodes, soldered, clipped, wrote software, flashed to an Elite-C, inserted that to the board, did a successful tweezer test, put on deodorant/a fresh T-shirt, walked to Middlemont, said hello to Ryan/Max, sat in a chair, rescued Bellah after Hannah arrived, sat back down, brainstormed spooky Americana songs.*⁷³³

Ross, Hannah and Max went out to the garden, found Melissa, went back inside, brainstormed venues/promotion ideas. Melissa and Max went to Swannanoa. Ross and Hannah went to the WALK, ordered food, saw Julian, got in the Prius, dropped Ross off at his house, where he cleaned up soldering bits.¹⁰⁴¹ He shopped for switches/caps, decided on Keebio, bemoaned the total price, had the bright idea to search Walmart, made purchases, looked at his phone,¹²⁵² took a bath.

vii.xxii

Ross woke and felt a fear of rotting. He procrastinated on coffee a while, brushed his teeth, played Wordle (BURNT in five,) looked at Travis' Fossil PCB firmware, thought he found the problem, texted Scott about Jake Grondy's Ever-Expanding offer from weeks ago, got a text from Kev about checking on Chuck,¹²¹⁵ which was a miscommunication.

He put clothes in his laundry basket, drank another coffee, made his bed, talked to Hannah on the phone for a while about the Ryan/Melissa

problem, scoured Discord, printed journal pages, researched magnets, thought about Layercase redesign possibilities, a larger Shortcut, his business in general.²²²

He wrote in his scratch notebook: *I put my laundry etc. in the car, drove to Silverball Subs, ordered an Italian w/ dill pickle chips + Cheerwine, ate half, drove to Waterford, fed the cats, hunted around for wifi, sat on the sectional, looked at my phone, ate the rest of my sandwich, started laundry.*

Hannah came over after class. We talked, cuddled, pet cats. She decided to go home and I gave her directions. I laid on the bed with Ophelia for a while charging my phone, but, when she left, realized I wanted to be back on the couch.

VII.XXIII

I woke to early texts from Hannah & Alex; Kevin wouldn't be able to play Shakori. I soon got a call from her, told her everything would be alright, went back to sleep. First, actually, Merlin had woke me for food.

I slept til 1130, found beans, boiled water, ground the beans, fed Chester, started a French press, went outside, charged my phone, sat at the table with Chester, wrote, poured coffee.¹²⁰³ I also played Wordle (WATER in five) and forgot to mention the main thing I did yesterday was finally successfully visualize how to design a sturdy 3DP Shortcut case for a smaller printer.

I brought in the trash, checked the mail, ate a banana, continued to drink coffee, visualized my afternoon.¹²⁵⁶

I went to put on clean clothes from the dryer, but they were hella damp, so I put that on for another hour, grabbed On Quality, finished that. I sat in the sun for a moment, thought about how Danny's 3D prints use long bolts inserted from underneath. He said essentially that one just threads them into a 1.9mm hole.

I decided I would go that route, visualized how I could make cases out of [smaller] parts, started thinking about broader product line, daughter boards, port expanders, etc. My clothes finally dried so I got dressed, drove to Mizu, called Hannah, ate chicken udon, went to Downing, loaded part of the PA, drove to the arboretum, greeted Thomas, listened to him, tried to help him get a little louder, took further measures for Hannah's set, broke down, went back to Downing, made love, ate cereal, returned to Waterford, ate pasta, went to sleep.

VII.XXIV

I dreamed of being in weird Philly houses, then a back alley with 9th Wonder. I went into Keebio, realized I was time traveling, got woken up by Ophelia cuddles. I thought about how that could be an interesting story: a time traveler trying to prove himself by predicting a world event on television, but being wrong, deciding he must be on a different timeline, then meeting his son/self.

I played Wordle (QUAKE in three,) texted Hannah, started coffee, talked to her on the phone, sat on the floor.¹⁰⁴⁹

Ross drank more coffee, checked the mail, cleaned the French press, watered potted plants, changed his shirt, drove to Silverball, ate a half Dolly, continued to Meyers, opened his Keebio keycaps, transcribed journal entries.³²⁴

From the scratch notebook: I drove to Downing, looked for Hannah, realized she was over at Kathryn/Tim's. We hung in their living room for a bit, walked back next door, kissed goodbye. I drove to Hillcrest, went inside, said hello to Leann, who was cutting up watermelon, gave me an Athletica Light. We went outside, hung with Scott, Nephew Charlie, Clay, had a fire, mostly listened to Clay talk a lot.

He left. I slowly said my goodbyes, drove to Waterford, got naked, ate like four packs of crackers, went to sleep.

VII.XXV

Lots of texts blowing me up: pics from the ballgame, Hannah on the news. I wanted to sleep more, was getting cat cuddles, but had big FOMO. I laid on the guest bed for some reason, decided everything was alright, made (weak) coffee, fed the cats, went outside, charged my phone, wrote.¹²¹¹

I talked to Hannah, drank coffee, looked at my phone, watered the garden.²¹⁰

I hung around the house, started researching 3D printers, wondering if the business might need a rebrand. Potential names I thought of include Hungry Cat, Sleepy Cat, 2Cat, Moss, Fwuit, Blackbear, Menu, Story, Chapter, 360, Mossberry, Clementine ... Bagu?

I drove to Downing, woke up Hannah. We went to Chipotle, ordered food, continued to Pisgah, sat down next to Martha, ate, were surprised to learn that they had built a new indoor venue. We watched Alex Kreug combo featuring new members Laura Boswell & Drummer Ryan, socialized, danced, drove to Downing, kissed goodnight.

I drove to Waterford, looked into choc stabilizers, went to sleep.

VII.XXV

My alarm went off at 9 and I snoozed it for ten minutes. I had a text from Steve asking about playing Aryuprana. I scooped liter, put dishes away, fed/watered, gathered belongings, played Wordle (HAUNT in five,) checked the mail, did chess puzzles, listened to a memo from Scott, got in the car, went to Exxon, got \$10 in gas/coffee.

I drove to Hillcrest, let Myrtle out, ate blueberries, goulash, pizza, charged my phone, talked to my dad, wrote.¹¹³¹ I drove to Downing, sat

w/ Myrtle on the chair while Hannah gathered her things. I helped a little with packing the car, put Myrtle on Hannah's lap, drove to Meyers, grabbed rain coat, black jacket, blue blanket, weighted planked, duffel, headlamp, chatted with Stephen, got back in the car, drove west on 240, got off at Smoky Park, put \$25 of gas in the car, drove to Thomas' house, dropped off his power adapter, drove all the way to Teaberry Hill.

I parked next to the main structure, tooted my horn. Hannah said I was gonna have to toot louder than that, but Becky immediately, excitedly appeared, showed us the ropes. We settled on a site by the creek, put Myrtle on a rope, set up the tent/hammock, talked about our anxieties, had hammock/chair time.

I got into the hammock with Hannah, read a chapter of Free Play.

We drove to the Stecoah Cultural Arts Center on Becky's recommendation, sat on the porch w/ a banjo picker, ate dinner, realized the main performance was with Unspoken Tradition. We drove to Robinsville, found an ice cream truck, got Myrtle a pup cup, ate at a nice table, drove back to Teaberry talking about borderline personality disorder.

We walked the trail, threw frisbee with Myrtle, got water from the fridge, went to bed.

VII.XXVI

Woke from dreams of hip-hop shows. Hannah made coffees. I walked down to the restroom, charged my phone, got my notebook, wrote.⁹²⁴

From a random text file on Ross's iMac via Nano in the terminal:

We drove to Lucy in the Rye, ate. I sat on the corner with Myrtle while Hannah checked out the local outfitter. I drove us to Hannah's house, shuffled some things

around, went to check on Merlin and Ophelia, then to Hillcrest.

I dropped off Myrtle, drove to Leo's House of Thirst, sat with Alyse/Melissa Stutts. We watched Steve, Evan, Kevin, Jacob play music, were joined by Hannah, Clay, Becca, David Wimbesh, Jay Moyle, plenty others. I walked Hannah to her car, rode to Aldi, walked around with her, kissed goodbye, got in my car, drove to Hillcrest. I stayed up til 1:30 doing Shortcut case design, eventually realizing there was nothing connecting the two halves.

VII.XXVIII

I woke, made six cups of coffee, came up with a janky solution to the Shortcut case, designed a cooler keyboard, ate, did the whole PCB, lost track of time. It was after eight when I called Hannah, drove to Ingles, bought hop water, continued to Downing, ate mac n' cheese + hot dogs, watched pottery, drove back to Hillcrest, redid the CN-634 PCB over and over again. I tried to sleep at 4AM, but didn't really do very much.

VII.XXIX

I woke around 9:30 after rocket ship dreams, did some 2D case mockup, struggled with Wordle (OMEGA in three.)¹²⁵³

Back to the scratch notebook: *I did the case design for 634 in one go, collaborated w/ ChatGPT on some logos for Catnap, made a sandwich, opened a Cheerwine, found it disgusting.*⁶¹⁵

I painstakingly added switches and keycaps to the model of what I decided to call Double, researched ways to do it better using Discord/ChatGPT. I tried

to sleep, but kept getting up to experiment with things.

VII.XXX

I did eventually sleep though and it made me very tired after dreams of working at a gas station, dealing with active shooters. I got up, let Myrtle out, ate blueberries/apple, started a load of laundry.

Ross fed the cats, opened a bubbly water, made coffee, fed Myrtle, asked ChatGPT for help getting the journal git up to date on his iMac, transcribed five days of entries,¹²³⁴ took a bath,¹²⁰ watched videos about force sensitive resistors for drum triggers,¹⁵⁰ made a sandwich.

He drove to Jeff Sipes' house, had an efficient rehearsal with Lillie Syracuse and others, saw Melissa on his way out, got in the car, talked to Hannah, got \$10 of gas, drove to Hillcrest, made a sandwich, talked with ChatGPT, talked to Hannah, started a very basic 60% keyboard design, went back and forth between bed.

vii.xxxi

Ross woke, placed switches, went back to bed, got up around noon, placed diodes, found out about Asheville Makers thanks to ChatGPT, did some routing.³¹⁸

Ross asked ChatGPT to write his journal for him:

Since my last entry, things have been a blur in the best kind of way. Yesterday, I went to Downing and helped Hannah load up the Space Bug, then headed over to Pritchard to set up the PA. The energy in the park was unreal – maybe the wildest I've ever seen – a kind of collective spark buzzing through everyone. Afterward, I stopped by Sweets n' Seats, then dropped the PA back off and made my way to Hillcrest.

Spent the evening deep in the keyboard design – I stayed up late sketching, measuring, and figuring out how to rotate the middle PCB so the Pro Micro could sit just right, while the signal passed through the side boards.

VIII.I

My alarm went off at 8, and I stumbled out of bed to make coffee before heading to WNCW. Played in Studio-B with Lillie, which was a treat as always.

From there, drove to Hendersonville to meet Hannah for lunch at Black Bear. Sat with her a bit while she talked to her boss on the phone. Hit traffic on 26 afterward and really had to pee – finally stopped at Meyers, where I grabbed those header pins I'd been thinking about and chatted for a bit with Stephen.

Then it was back to Hillcrest to let Myrtle out, picked up some tapes from UPS, laid on the couch, scrolled through and shared a few reels, and wound down talking to ChatGPT about this design.

All in all, a long but satisfying stretch – a mix of running around, music, little technical victories, and stolen moments of rest. Feels good to have it all down.⁴²⁰

Ross did design work until Hannah arrived in a rain storm at 9:30, crying with a frozen pizza and ginger beer. She had already been heading toward a meltdown but Ross really didn't want to drive to West Asheville. They spent a while cuddling, and, as soon as she ate, she felt better. They watched an episode of pottery. Hannah left. Ross opened up OnShape but got frustrated and was brutally tired, fell asleep.

viii.ii

Ross woke from many vivid, active dreams, felt more tired than before he had fallen asleep. Leann texted saying they wouldn't be back til 330 or 430, so Ross went back to sleep until 1130. He got up then, opened a La Croix, did circles around the house, folding one shirt, recycling one item, packing away one belonging until the house was clean.

He left at 2, drove to Meyers, slowly alternated between laying in bed and loading things in, looking at his phone, setting up his computer, and, eventually, writing.³¹⁶ He spent a while being patient in Onshape until, finally, he felt like he had correctly created a model for an MX keyswitch with an R1-1U keycap that could be easily replicated across a PCB.⁴¹³

Ross drove to All Day Darling, brought in some hardware, ordered a burger, started to set up, ate, finished setting up, played two fun sets with Ryan/Dulaney, called Hannah, drove to the Brew Pump, bought hop water, went down to Downing, talked about calendars, 3D printers, sewing machines, drove up to Meyers.¹¹²³ He played around with switches and keycaps in Onshape but eventually abandoned, listened to his houseguest blasting *That 70s Show*.

viii.iii

Ross woke to his alarm, walked to the market, got a sandwich/coffee, walked to Morgan's Comics, said aloha to the art class, swept, accepted some cards, hung with Hannah, sold lots of stuff, ate, locked up, took out the trash, walked down to Downing, ate pizza, watched Pottery, cuddled on the couch, took grapes, ate them on the way to Meyers, tackled Onshape and finally crafted composite switch/cap parts that could be selectively hidden for a 60% keyboard, namely Tabby.¹²⁴⁴

viii.iv

Ross wrote in his notebook:

*I slept hard, woke at 11, didn't really want to walk on account of the seemingly looming rain. I sucked it up, packed my bag, printed journal pages, which required getting my Mac file up to date. I walked straight to the bank, deposited \$120, went to High Five, ordered a coffee in a ceramic mug, played Wordle (RIGID in three,) edited pages 9-12, wrote.*¹⁵⁵

Ross walked to the west side, noticed it was 3PM, went to UJ, sat next to Tom Cornish, ordered turkey pita w/ tots & Coke, ate, walked to Izzy's, ordered a drip, wat on the porch, talked to Hannah, walked down to Middlemont, set up drums, had a fun and surprisingly productive rehearsal with Bellah, June, Melissa, Amanda, Amber, Ryan, Dulci, Kevin, started by two songs with Lillie, who was joined by her partner.

Rehearsal finished and Ross walked up to Haywood, running into Casey, Alan, Wendi at UJ. Hannah was frantically trying to find him at that point, was parked in front of the Hop. Ross walked to her, apologized, rode down to Downing, ate cherries, made love, went to bed.

viii.v

Ross woke, shortly heard Hannah's alarm, cuddled, helped her drum out the pattern to her alarm, got dressed, worried Hannah that they were not sticking to their coffee tradition. He walked to Ingles, bought grapes, sparkling water, peas, ramen, went to Bad Manners, ordered a drip, walked to Meyers.⁹¹²

He finished his PCB rework and case design for Tabby with just enough time to walk to the market, buy a burrito, call his dad for his 80th birthday, talk to his sister, chug his burrito, sit impatiently through a meeting with Ryan, Melissa,

Hannah, Bellah, June, Max, walk with Hannah for a bit talking about what was wrong until she had to pedal away for class.

He went to Odd's, ordered a coffee, walked to Meyers, made a slight design adjustment, got in the Camry, drove to Asheville Makers on Coxe for open house, met a bunch of cool nerds and admired equipment. He drove home, ordered the Tabby PCB with Slab bottom, soldered switches into Shortcut, talked to Hannah, ate beet salad from Bri, got some calipers from the basement, did a little bit of Shortcut case redesign, fell asleep.

viii.vi

Ross woke a bit before his alarm, attached a second PCB to the underside of Shortcut, typed journal entries on it.⁸¹⁴ He left the house, walked to Taco Billy, had teary conversation with anxious/sad Hannah, turned the mood around, got in the Space Bug, rode to Meyers, kissed goodbye.¹⁰²⁷

He lay down, came close to a nap, got his Shortcut keyboard in a bit more working order, moved it to the iMac desk and Palmetto to the Air desk.¹²⁴⁸

He got his burrito out of the fridge, started eating it on the front porch, realized he was ready to head down to Downing, gathered his journals/mug, packed his bag, walked down, went inside, snacked on blueberries mango, chocolate, crackers, made a sandwich, installed Tuxedo on his Chromebook, installed KiCad 5, had ChatGPT help him set up SSH for his GitHub account, tried to upgrade KiCad, ran out of disk space, laid on the couch looking at his phone, talked to Hannah, went to sleep.

ix.vii

Ross woke, played Wordle, opened a lemon seltzer, filled the kettle, gave the cats water, cleaned their litter, walked up to Odd's, ordered a drip, drank it on the back porch, went to Meyers, trimmed his beard, changed his shirt.¹⁴⁷ He got dressed, drove to the Grey Eagle, arrived around 2:30, slowly loaded in/set up, ordered a burrito, ate on the back patio, sat by the front door.

He let in Amber. They waited a while for everyone who was late due to traffic or no reason at all. He checked sounds, hung out in the green room, greeted Hannah, watched Lillie, played a fun set with Ryan, Melissa, Amanda, Dulci, Amber, Kevin, packed up, loaded out, drove to Downing, cuddled in bed, slept.

viii.viii

Ross woke to Hannah's alarm, stayed in bed a while, made her a coffee, went to the living room, looked at his phone, got dressed, drove to Meyers.⁹²⁴

He ate grapes, changed clothes, walked up to the Market, bought a burrito/Italian/coffee, sat in the window, ate, greeted Lamont/Casey, walked down to Morgan's Comics, immediately set off the alarm, called Morgan with no answer, called Bird, realized he was pressing *STAY* instead of *OFF*, got the alarm disabled, started counting the drawer, had to open the store, lost count of the drawer, got a flood of customers right away, recounted the drawer.

He had a lull after that, swept, tidied, eventually got visits from the Reckards, Hannah. Bird was a little late, but soon arrived, so he clocked out, walked to Haywood Famous, ordered an Americano, walked to the top of Brevard, realized he still had the store keys, walked back east, dropped them off, chatted with Bird, walked to Meyers.⁷⁰³

He restarted the Shortcut case design with 18mm side walls, hiding the rightmost column, chatted

with ChatGPT, decided to make them 17.2mm to match the middle area, drafted that, took a bath.⁹⁰⁵

Ross called Hannah, walked down to her neighborhood, ran into her/Kathryn/Suli on the streets, went to Downing, chilled on the couch while they talked, eventually watched an episode of pottery, snuggled, went to bed.

viii.ix

Ross woke to Hannah's alarm, made a coffee, went back to bed. Hannah went to water aerobics. Ross walked to Battle Cat. It was too busy, so he went to Community, drank an espresso at the bar, walked down to River Arts, saw Francis, Grant, Kevin Smith, met up with Hannah, toured Pink Dog, went to Olde London Road, ate, walked to the car, drove to Foundy, saw the temporary woodworking space, drove to High Wire, found nothing of interest, got in the car, rode to Meyers, took a poop.¹³¹

Ross rested for a while, got dressed, drove the windy route to Cedar Mountain, stopping for gas. He loaded in his stool, greeted Charlie, set up the rest of his drums, got a GuinNA, greeted the rest of the band, checked sounds, ate beans/rice, played a very fun set with Melissa, Dulci, Alyse, Ryan, Charlie, broke down, loaded out, sat next to the fire that had never been started, called Hannah, said his goodbyes, got in the car, drove to Downing, where he and Hannah cuddled in bed.

viii.x

Ross woke, looked at his phone for an hour, cuddled Hannah, made coffees, drank, made love, took a bath, helped with stir fry, ate, had a lie-down, drove to Leo's, watched Steve play with Jaze/Zac Goober, grabbed Ryan, drove to the Colliseum, watched a bit of Sylvan Esso followed by Bernie Sanders, walked to Mamacita's with Hannah/Gary, ate a burrito w/ Chips

& Coke, walked back to the Space Bug in Montford, drove to Downing.

He sat in the chair, ate a popsicle, pet Suli, talked with Kathryn, said goodnight, got in the Camry, drove to Meyers, got his hex screws out of the mailbox.⁹⁴⁴

viii.xi

Ross woke, eventually made some coffee, found an A1 Mini on Marketplace, messaged the buyer, laid around while waiting for UPS to show up, received the Tabby 0.1 PCBs, drove to FBRA girl-edition, started to help Melissa set up a new drum set, got in the car, called Hannah, drove to 12 Bones South, ordered a BBQ sammy w/ mac n' cheese, baked beans, Cheerwine, greeted Hannah, met the Mini seller, paid \$220 cash, chatted with Hannah some more.

He drove to Downing, set up the printer, started the Tabby case print, opened the PCBs, soldered diodes.⁹¹² Hannah came over and they cuddled on the bed. The print finished not long after she departed and Ross soon realized most of the holes were too small, especially in the top shell. He fiddled with them forever nonetheless, did a test print that snapped right on and then redesigned half a topshell to attempt the snap-on method.²²⁴

viii.xii

Ross attached the topshell, found it too boxy, designed one with 1% fillet, added another stubborn piece to the print, sent it, went back to bed, talked to Hannah, ran out of black filament, finished the job with white.¹⁰⁴⁴

Ross realized he had a hex screwdriver, left the house, got a coffee, a ham n' cheese croissant, coffee for Hannah, went down to Downing, checked on the cats, took a rest, walked back to Bad Manners, ordered another drip, walked to Meyers, dealt with Mr. Van, desoldered switches, drove to Middlemont,

learned *The Christmas Song* with Tina, Melissa, Dulci, Max, Bellah, June, drove back to Meyers, finished soldering switches, talked to Hannah, who said he sounded hungry, packed things in the Camry.⁹²⁰

Ross drove to the WALK, ate a patty melt w/ tots & Coke, continued down to Downing, where he lay on the couch, the bed. He decided the simplest way to handle mounting the controller on Tabby would be to fix/reorder the Slab design, so he did that, went back to bed, had a hard time falling asleep.

viii.xiii

Ross woke, kept an eye on the weather. His phone said it would be raining, but he thought otherwise. They came to an agreement at the last minute, so he left the house on foot, turned around, grabbed his brushes, went to Battle Cat, ordered a double shot, walked down the hill, across the bridge, decided on two more shots at the Summit truck.

He went to Citizen Studios, helped Tina load in, had a fun time recording *The Christmas Song* with her, Ryan, Melissa, Dulci, Gar. As soon as it came together, he said, "Oh, I should see if Steve's in the neighborhood!" Steve said he was, said he had talked to Gar the day before, had been listening to the song that morning, had just tuned the piano and would be picking Ellis up around the corner in an hour, so he came in and ripped virtuosity all over the track.

The session ended. Ross went to a bench, talked to Hannah, saw the weather turning, hung up, realized he had walked off with Gar's fob, returned it, went to High Five, ordered a drip, looked at cute keycaps in the Bambu app, walked to Grey Eagle, held the door open for people while they loaded in, drove the Electric Bug to Downing and back for Hannah's merch, had yet another very meaningful Golden Folk with appearances from The Moon & You, David Wimbesh, Elizabeth Mcorvey.

Ross and Hannah went to Downing, drank decaf, chatted in bed. Ross ran out of battery and went to sleep in the middle room.

viii.xiv

Ross woke to Hannah's footsteps, cuddled, made coffees, drank and got stumped on Wordle in the living room. Hannah correctly suggested KNEEL for guess number five. They walked about Catnap and she departed for work. Ross moved his printer from the trunk to the front seat, drove to Meyers for magnets, decided to sit down and write in his journal,¹⁰²⁵ desolder the rightmost column from Shortcut.¹⁰⁴⁵

Ross went to Best Buy, found filament, sat in the car a while, decided to drive to Montford, parked in front of Hummingbird park, walked to Forager, ordered a half-priced sandwich, coke, chips. The owner said his sub-\$9 meal was very economical. He said, "Reminds me of 2007!"

She said, "Ah, that was not a good time for my finances. I lost 40% of my assets after that."

"You should have tried not having anything to begin with!"

"It's okay, I made it all back."

He said, "That's good," went to a window booth, ate, walked to Pritchard, thought about the Shortcut case, realized he would need more things from Meyers, got up to walk to his car, decided to play a game of chess with a lude stranger, ran into Jesse Smathers, got to the Camry, drove to Meyers, where Bri was having a rave. He replaced the Shortcut top-mounted Elite-C with a bottom-mounted Pro Micro, replaced the 4mm screws with 10mm.¹⁵⁶

Ross drove to Izzy's, ordered a dark roast + a Devil's Foot Paloma, sat in a comfy chair. Leann soon texted saying they were leaving, so he went to his car, grabbed his mug, transferred his coffee, started driving, realized he had left his screws at Meyers, went back there, grabbed those, drove to

Hillcrest, greeted the critters, unloaded his lived-in-looking car.

He did four or five disheartening test prints of the bottom half-plates for Shortcut, talked to Hannah, sleepily crafted one more hail Mary that included side walls, went to bed but kept getting up to fix snagged filament. At one point, he went sideways over the futon but luckily landed on soft couch with his butt.

viii.xv

Ross woke around 7:30, checked his print and was shocked to see that it snapped together with the PCB like a magazine into a gun; it didn't even need mounting standoffs! He made coffee, checked in with Melissa, let Myrtle out, designed a comparable left half with shorter walls, higher lip, magnet inserts, rounder edges, drove to FBRA-for-girls, had *It Drums* for maybe nine different kits, made \$48, drove back to Hillcrest, played around in Onshape, started printing.¹¹³⁹

Ross was happy with the way his right half turned out, designed and printed the left one in sport mode so that it would be done by 3:10. He drove to Chipotle, parked in the BLZ, picked up food, went to Downing, ate with Hannah. They were a little sluggish packing the car, drove to PC Productions off exit 66, greeted Kevin/Dulaney.

Ross rode Jackson's OneWhell while they set up, listened to sound check, hung on the porch, greeted/chatted with the eight guests as they arrived, watched a very special show, had a quick visit to the outside world, went back in the brightly lit submarine, watched another set with encore, chatted, loaded out, drove to Downing, kissed Hannah goodnight, went to Meyers, printed another half, slept.

viii.xvi

Ross woke around 10, very tired, made coffee, inspected the Shortcut keyboard. He did a small print to test bridging over the USB cable. The height was okay and he was amazed that it printed in right-side-up orientation, but the screw holes did not line up with the rest of the case and he started to realize the implications of the 1mm gap between halves. He thought for a while and eventually decided the board must need more clearance on the sides, so he designed a left-half print where the inside wall was .5 mm further to the left, started printing, continued drinking coffee, looked at his phone, laid on the couch with Myrtle.¹³⁴

He did more designing, closed the gap, started printing side-top pieces, drove to All Day Darling, set up outside, ate burger/tots/Coke, greeted Charlie, started getting drizzled on, which turned into a downpour. They moved inside, dilly dallied a bit, set up in a puddle, played a set, took a break, again, again.

Ross drove to Hillcrest, did sides again, talked to Hannah, slept until about 5:30, printed some more.

viii.xvii

Ross woke around nine, put together a fairly complete-looking Shortcut, drove to Downing, set up drums, made coffee, greeted Charlie then Jeff, had a very fun rehearsal, drove to Meyers, picked up fancy clothes, drove to Taco Billy, picked up food, went to Fleetwood's, ate tacos outside wall talking with photographer Erin, greeted Hannah, got dressed, realized he had left his boots at Meyers.

He drove to grab them, returned to Fleetwood's, took photos with Ryan/Hannah/Melissa in the coffin, booth, bench, stage, said his goodbyes, drove to Hillcrest, had a quick chat with Hannah, fell asleep.

He woke around seven, felt hungry, struggled to decide what to eat, drove to the Salt Faced Mule, ate brisket mac n' cheese, drank Coke, went back to Hillcrest. He thought about what design steps to take next but decided it was time to clean up. He started laundry, put the iMac/printer in his car, cleaned up bits n' bobs, lay on the couch, changed over laundry, wrote in his journal.⁹³⁶

He laid on the couch, talked to Hannah, soon fell asleep, dreamed many dreams.

viii.xviii

Ross woke around 9:30 feeling extremely tired from so much dreaming. He did circles around the kitchen, made coffee, sat back down on the couch, got a text from Leann saying they would not be back home until 11PM. He finished a cup, cleaned the litter, drank another, ate a tiny bit of briskit mac, drove to Meyers, took out the recycling.

Steve caught him up on what an exciting week had been while Ross took things inside and opened mail. He drove down to Middlemont, greeted Tina, set up the house kit, ran through the upcoming Pony set, looked up his UPS delivery, hunted down the driver, talked to Hannah, drove to Hillcrest, checked the mail, re-upped the BBQ sauce and salt in his briskit mac, did the dishes,³⁴⁵ laid on the couch, looked at his phone, took a bath.⁶¹⁹

Ross did some typing tests, sojme more vegging, accidentally let Myrtle go on an adventure.⁷⁵⁴ He got in the Camry, drove to Downing, said hi to Kathryn/Suli, preheated the oven, greeted Hannah, put pizza in, did the dishes, watched the series six finale of Throwdown, made love, fell asleep.

Ross woke when Hannah was walking around. She made coffee. He drank it on the couch. She left for work and he walked to the bank, deposited \$150, walked to High Five, asked if Hannah wanted to get lunch; she was just going to grab something quick and get back to work. He walked to Downing, got in the Camry, drove to Jersey Michael's, ate a #3 mini, bought grapes/Mandies from Aldi, drove to Meyers, drove Stephen to Lowe's, got a hose for the kitchen sink.

They went back to Meyers, where Ross sat in his room and decided it wouldn't do. He said, "I'm about to make a royal mess of the living room for a couple days." Stephen said that was okay. He moved things out there, moved the dresser over by the door, moved the wooden desk in front of the window, put the double cubby to the left of that, put the TV on top.

He put the 3D printer in between the TV and the dresser, walked out of the house, called UJ, ordered a turkey pita w/ tots, sat at the bar, got a splash of Coke from Wes, ate, went to Odd's, ordered drip, walked down to Middlemont, talked to Hannah, went inside, set up drums, realized he was a half-hour early to rehearsal again, laid in bed. Melissa, Dulci soon arrived.

Ross smoked weed, had a good rehearsal with The Moon and You, called Hannah, walked up to the Brew Pump, ordered an Athletica, sat and drank with Michel, Maria, Chad, Wendi, Jake, Jackie, Casey and (wow I can't believe I forgot her name.) He walked up Haywood, ran into Stephen at the top of Brevard, walked to Meyers, started to put his room back together while watching Spirited Away, most notably plugging the TV into the speakers.¹¹⁵²

Ross messed around with brass inserts, went to bed.

viii.xx

Ross woke, did a test print of the Tabby sidewall with larger holes, possibly a couple top prints. He merged all the lower parts into larger halves, started printing one of those, walked to Ingles, bought grape juice, coffee, went to Bad Manners, got a drip, back to Meyers, did keyboard stuff while barely watching Ninja Turtles.

He printed another bottom half, talked to Hannah, who said she would pick him up for Haunted rehearsal, which happened right as he was able to start the top prints. They rode to Middlemont, ate Chick-Fil-A, had a fun rehearsal with Ryan & Melissa, rode back to Meyers. He showed Hannah his newly rearranged room, soldered inserts into the top print, put on TMNT again, ended up watching the whole thing with Hannah, who had a little cry about life afterwards.

They kissed goodbye. He started soldering the Slab with hotswap header pins, watched Disney's Robinhood, installed a pro micro upside down, desoldered it, got into some kind of crazy murk with writing the software. Everything that could have gone wrong did, but, after isolating problems, adding and moving three jumper wires, eventually, Tabby passed a tweezer test. Ross shivered with excitement, got his laptop off the bookcase, wrote journal on the Shortcut.⁴⁵⁶

viii.xxi

Ross woke around 8:30, alternated between cleaning his room and going back to bed, started soldering switches, made coffee, finished switches, added stabs, struggled to find one last stab without realizing it was on his desk. He did wires that could be hidden inside the Tabby case for the three missing pins, added keycaps, continued to struggle with keycap evenness and stabs.

He eventually called it finish, went into a bit of shock, got a call from Hannah, had a hard time talking, laid in bed for a rain storm, got dressed, drove to Brew Pump, bought \$20 of gas, walked across the street, bought a flavor bomb burrito and filled his coffee cup.

He drove to Saluda, sat in his car until Amanda arrived at 4:55, went inside, set up drums, ordered a smash burger, laid in the grotto, checked sounds, ate, drank coffee on the sidewalk, took a big poop, played a fun set, packed up, drank an Athletic while the band counted money and talked *Royal Suits* drama. He packed up his rug, drove to 26, called Hannah, talked to her halfway to Meyers, went inside, chatted with Stephen, watched some of Babe, designed an idea he had for a wedged Tabby bottom, moved his journal to the iMac, wrote.¹¹⁵¹

Ross messed around with angled bases, went to bed.

viii.xxii

Ross woke at seven when Stephen's Walmart delivery arrived. He turned on the coffee maker, went back to bed, asked ChatGPT what the height differential should be for his desired typing angle. He printed a wedge with screw holes, talked to Hannah, liked the print, made another, drank coffee, set an alarm for work.¹²⁰⁷

He dozed, drove up to Morgan's Comics, swept, took over for Bird, farted around the store until they got back at five, dilly dallied a bit more, drove to Starbucks, got a latte + a saus-egg/chee, got on 26, talked to Hannah, arrived at Eda's Hideaway, loaded in, greeted friends, ate Taco Billy with Hannah.

He checked sounds, which turned into rehearsal, played a slightly frustrating set with Ryan, Melissa, Dulci, celebrated Gary's birthday with Fox, Jason, Dulaney, Charlie, Tina, John, Barb, Carol, Beth, Bob, took a break, played more, packed up,

loaded out, got on 26, arrived at Downing, cuddled in bed.

viii.xiii

Ross woke when Hannah made him coffee. She went to the living room while he drank/dozed. She went to Story Parlor for a day-long festival of workshops. He napped under the weighted blanket until about noon, drove to LaZoom, greeted Matt, Rigel, loaded in, checked sounds, got eel sushi, played one of the most fun ever sets with Dulci/Kevin on the way to Highland, New Belgium, Wedge.

They rode downtown, quickly packed up. Kevin went off for work and Ross booked it to the Purple Onion. He was the first one there, set up drums, ordered the salmon special, ate in the grotto, greeted Ryan, got a coffee, went out to the sidewalk, sat in the sun, greeted Melissa, Kathy, Ron, went inside, played a fun set, stole the show with a drum solo, packed up, headed out, got on 26, talked to Hannah, drove to Meyers, ate chocolate peanut butter cake with extra chocolate sauce.¹⁰⁵³

viii.xiv

Ross woke, grabbed a bag, drove to Brew Pump, got \$20 of gas, walked across the street to the market but found them closed. He drove to Ingles, bought grapes/CheezIt, went over to Bad Manners, ordered a drip, got in the car, drove to Somewhere Tennessee, met Gary/Fox at a Subway, realized they should have carpooled, ate.

They caravanned to a marina, ran into some other West Asheville folks, loaded up a pontoon, set sail with Ryan, Melissa, Chelsea, Silas. They ventured out in the rain to the other end of the lake, took a dip, drove back to the marina, picked up Dulci/Amanda, took a shorter trip, enjoyed the sunshine, soaked, returned, said their goodbyes.

Ross drove to West Asheville, swung by Starbucks, ordered an egg sando + short drip, went to Downing, ate while Hannah was out walking, chatted with her. They made a frozen pizza, talked about what to watch for a while, settled on a Brit Box show: Ludwig, watched two episodes, went to bed.

viii.xxv

Ross woke, felt gassy, cuddled with Hannah, kissed her goodbye for work. He drove to Meyers, took a bath/nap, left the house on foot, ran into Michael Basso, made small talk with him the whole way to the market, ate a tub of kale under the tree, drank some probiotic lemonade, walked over to Rowan, got comped a coffee courtesy of Maddie.

He walked to Meyers, drank his coffee, wrote.²¹⁷ He sat on the porch until Tina arrived, drove with her out to Brasstown, pulled into the music barn, set up, checked sounds, went to the cafeteria for dinner, played a fun set with Ryan/Melissa, packed up, said goodbye to his friends, followed T-Claw around campus, helped him stow a speaker, found his lodging for the night, Hill House 360. He talked to Hannah, took a bath, went to sleep, dreamed about a chaotic marching band reunion.

viii.xxvi

Ross' alarm went off at 6:42. He wasn't sure he wanted to get up, but he eventually did, packed up, walked to the main building, drank coffee in a chair, took an Alexander Technique class, had breakfast, drove to Meyers.¹¹¹²

Ross opened mail, did a test print of the M3 screw/insert setup, realized it wouldn't work without ordering new PCBs anyway, walked down the hill, over the bridge, sat at the bus stop, did chess puzzles, walked up the hill, went into Pack Square, sat on a bench, saw JB, who looked

suspiciously sober, started a game of chess with him, went to the bank, deposited \$225.

Ross walked to Asheville Forager, ate a very disappointing sandwich, drank a baby OJ, went to High Five, ordered a drip, sat in the park, drank for a few, decided he was excited to get back west and do Catnap things. He stopped at every bus stop and had ChatGPT tweak the logo on the way back west, went into Ingles, bought two cans of peas + grape juice, went across the street, saw Eli Kahn at the farmer's market, walked to Meyers.⁴⁰³

He started to do some keyboard design but didn't get very far. Hannah called, and, based on the long pauses, Ross asked if she wanted a ride home from class, which she did. He picked her up outside of the Admiral and they drove to Brew Pump, bought 2x hop water, peanuts, Starburst Mini, rode down to Downing and hung on the couch. When Ross said he might go home, she made him stay. They talked a while about her facilitation project. When he said he might go lay down, she sent him home.

He tried designing a 3DP top for Rebound but got frustrated with how wabi-sabi his old design files were.

viii.xxvii

Ross woke with his nervous system activated, made coffee, finished the Rebound design, printed it while desoldering Wabi, which was easier than expected. He soldered the Outemu Skies into a Tabby PCB, drank more coffee, continued to design and print Rebound top iterations,²⁰¹ made peas/noodles, thought about how to announce the launch of Catnap Keyboards:

Ross Montsinger has a long-running interest in writing tools. In 2018, he designed a keyboard to make his side-gig (involving hours of daily typing) easier and more enjoyable. He sold parts for the design

online and was tickled to see more than 300 Rebound keyboards built all over the world.

In 2024, wanting a more hands-on endeavor, he cut and stitched together colorful leather journals from salvaged materials. The handcrafted nature and uniqueness of each numbered book delighted his artistic sensibilities, and, for as long as he could, he created one per day.

Enter Catnap Keyboards, a combination of these ideas. Each design will be fully assembled, unique, numbered, high-quality, hand-crafted, individually tested, ready to plug and type, meaning no special computer knowledge is necessary. They're as easy to use as a journal!

He got a random visit from Ashleigh, the person who was driving the car when he went over the cliff at Batcave Beau's house. She took pictures around the house, presumably for generating an estimate. Ross went back and forth with ChatGPT until his launch announcement looked like this:

Ross has long been drawn to tools that make writing enjoyable. In 2018, he designed a custom keyboard to make the intensive typing of his side gig easier and more comfortable. He sold the parts for the Montsinger Rebound online, which led to 300+ builds around the world.

In 2024, seeking something more hands-on, he began cutting and stitching colorful leather journals from salvaged materials. Each numbered book was unique, handcrafted, and infused with personality. For as long as he could, he made one every day.

Catnap Keyboards brings these two passions together: each keyboard is fully assembled,

unique, and numbered. They're high-quality, hand-crafted, individually tested, and ready to plug in and type – easy to use as a journal and just as personal.

Ross walked to Haywood Famous, but they were closed. He continued down to Downing, helped Hannah pack up her PA, drove up to Haywood, realized he needed to grab the key from Bird, did so, continued to Middlemont, had a short rehearsal with Ryan/Melissa, went to Ingles, bought liquid aminos, tomato sauce, a pizza, vegan ranch, went down to Downing, made spaghetti, watched two episodes of Ludwig, went to bed.

viii.xxviii

Ross woke a little later than Hannah, made a coffee, walked to the market, bought a Liquid Death, a sandwich, more coffee, walked to Morgan's Comics, had a slow day stocking issues and blocking things, got out at four, walked to Meyers, put things away, checked his prints from the day before and found they were quite janky. He restarted them upside down, laid in bed, looked at his phone.⁴⁵⁵

He drove to Downing, set up drums, had a good rehearsal with Charlie/Jeff, packed up, chilled on the couch, watched an episode of Ludwig, went to bed.

viii.xxix

Ross woke with Hannah, made a coffee, drove his car to Meyers, verified a print, started another, walked to the market, bought an Italian croissant/Liquid Death, coffee, walked east. He sat outside of the Rabbit Hole, refilled his coffee at 12 Baskets, went into work, had a very long/slow day, greeted Bird, walked to Downing, grabbed Hannah's headphones, went to Haywood Famous, got a quad latte.

He walked downtown, passing through all kinds of Asheville mayhem, ended up in the Mast tent by the stage for Boomtown. He ate candy, talked to friends/strangers, listened to some of Papadosio, helped Hannah cart items back to the store, ran into Taylor Martin, drove to Downing, laid on the floor, listened to Hannah talk to her sisters, laid in the middle room a bit, watched the last two episodes of Ludwig, went to bed.

viii.xxx

Ross woke around nine, made a coffee, walked to Ingles, bought two cans of peas, went over to Bad Manners, ordered a drip, continued to Meyers, put his cans away, turned on the coffee warmer, wrote.¹⁰¹² He soldered heat inserts into the Tabby #2 topshell, tested screw fit with the bottom, soldered header pins into an upside down slab, inserted a pro micro, rewrote the firmware, ran the necessary jumpers, got a working keyboard with quite a bit less headache than #1, washed his hands, cleaned his desk.¹⁰⁴

He made food, tested his wedge design, worked on a few more complicated ones that were combined with the side walls, inverted it, disconnected it from the sides, started a test print, made more coffee,⁵³⁵ rebooted his computer, talked to Hannah.⁵⁴⁵

He sent one more wedge to the printer, went to bed.

viii.xxxi

Ross woke early, dreamt his print had failed but was incorrect. He assembled the keyboard, realized he needed to take it all apart, trim the pins under the space bar. He did that, reassembled, enjoyed it; the switches are stiff, no longer silent; the caps are yellowed and dirty, but the case and its typing angle look/feel great.

He drove to Downing, set up drums, had a fun rehearsal with Charlie/Jeff, said goodbye to

Charlie, drove to Taco Billy, ate on the covered patio, drove to Downing. Hannah realized she had left her umbrella, so they drove to Taco Billy and back having good conversation. They said goodbye to Jeff, flirted with the idea of making love (Hannah and Ross,) parted ways instead. Ross drove up to Meyers, typed on Tabby #2.

He laid in bed, enjoyed some drizzle, talked to Hannah, decided no to go to baseball, told Steve as much, talked to Hannah again, changed their minds. He walked down to Downing, got in the Space Bug as Hannah was pulling out of her driveway. They sent out tickets, drove to the Tourists stadium, parked nearby, walked inside, found their seats in LL, were joined by Steve, his friend Tom, Ryan, Melissa, Max, Liore, Rachel(?), Kathryn, Mave, coincidentally Devin and his daughters, one of whom (Piper) bruised their hand trying to protect herself from a foul ball.

They played a few rounds of New Ball, had a good time, left as fireworks were going off. Ross and Hannah talked about cheating, bad relationships, drove to Meyers, kissed goodbye. Ross went inside, sat on the toilet, went to his room, felt relaxed, wrote.⁹³⁴

ix.i

Ross woke to his alarm but did not want to get up. He brushed his teeth, grabbed a hop water, never opened it, looked at his phone, walked via Olney to the market, bought an Itaian wrap, murder water, coffee, went to 12 Baskets, had a sit, went into Morgan's, turned off the alarm, flipped the switches, counted the drawer, opened up, had a day that fluctuated between slow/busy, got a coffee delivery from Hannah.

He chatted with a customer, counted the drawer, closed up, walked to Meyers, assembled a cleaner Tabby #2, typed on it.⁶³⁹ He rested and printed Rebound case attempts the rest of the night.

ix.ii

Ross woke, babysat the end of a print, left the house, had an Americano at Battle Cat, talked to Hannah, walked to the bank, deposited \$50 in cash, went to Forager, had an almost decent Italian sandwich w/ Coke, went to High Five, had a drip in the park, walked back west.⁴⁶⁵

He printed a spool holder while his spool rested on his cabasa, took a bath, designed another Rebound half attempt, sent it to the printer with its new spool holder, packed his bag, made a coffee, set up his Palmetto and noticed what a sturdy son-of-a-bitch it is.⁶⁰⁷

He walked down to Downing, greeted Hannah. They went together to the WALK, ate burgers, to Meyers, where Ross changed over a print, back to Downing. Ross fixed the vacuum while Hannah packed her bag. They went to bed around midnight.

ix.iii

Ross' alarm went off at 7:15, but he did not want to get up, and, despite getting brief cuddles from Hannah, it seemed she did not either. He got up around 7:45, made two coffees, got in the car, drove to Taylors, SC, got dropped off at Travis' shop. They painstakingly went through PCBA parts for Fossil 2, went over the matrix/JSON, got lunch at First Watch, said their goodbyes.

Ross went across the parking lot to Starbucks, ordered a short latte with a chocolate chip cookie, ate, looked at his phone, went outside, greeted Hannah, ate grapes, drove to Meyers, created a top for the Rebound case, printed a new side, walked to Odd's, ordered a coffee, went down to Middlemont, had a fun but tiring rehearsal with Dark Turn of Mind, crashed out, politely hurried Hannah along, got in the car, rode to Meyers, opened a spool of navy filament, wrote.⁹²⁶

Ross sprinted the side walls, felt tired/cranky, went to bed.

ix.iv

Ross wanted to sleep in, but woke at nine or ten. He Finalized the top prints, ran the middle one, tidied his room, took a bath, made some lunch: noodles n' black beans. He talked to Hannah, redid a Rebound side half to be 6mm taller, walked to Morgan's Comics, talked with Bird, picked up the key.

He went to Ingles, bought two cans of peas + some grape juice, went to Bad Manners, ordered an Americano, drank some of it out front, walked to Meyers, got talked at by Stephen.²²⁰ He drove to Downing, picked up Hannah, drove to High Five by the river, where he drank a drip and she had a tea/muffin.

They continued along the river to Zadie's, found a place to stand in the rain, ordered food, ate, chatted with lots of people, enjoyed a very good set from Tyler Ramsey, stood by the tracks, chatted with Kevin, Becca, Danni, Luke, Henry Tollis, drove back to Downing. They were tired, looked at their phones, went to bed.

ix.v

They woke. Ross made Hannah a coffee. She went to work and he drove to Meyers, hastily threw together a print. He walked to the market, bought a salami sandwich, coffee, murder water, walked to 12 Baskets, sat for five minutes, got a bit more coffee, clocked into Morgan's Comics, organized comics in bins until the last 90 mins of his shift, when he did nothing.

He walked to Meyers, threw together a print, talked to Hannah, walked down to Downing, helped her change litter, made spaghetti, watched the first episode of British Bake Off, put together a fantasy team, made love, went to bed.

Hannah woke, made Ross a coffee, went on a walk with Kathryn. Ross stayed in bed looking at his phone until she got back, did the dishes, looked at his phone some more, got dressed, FaceTimed with the Kaminers for their live Bake Off draft, was fairly happy with their team: Nataliaia, Nadia, Lesley, Leighton.

He kissed Hannah goodbye, went to Bad Manners, ordered a drip + a sausage/egg/cheese, walked to Meyers, messed with prints, ate, wrote.¹¹⁹ He relaxed until three, drove down to Downing, loaded up the car with Hannah, PA, Jeff, drove to Trailside Brewing, set up, played fun show to a muddy room, drank THC bevvies, packed up, drove to Downing, had an interesting cuddle with a non-stressed Hannah, went to sleep.

Ross woke slowly thanks to coffee from Hannah, said goodbye, drove up to Meyers, looked at a print for Rebound top mid, decided to do another with larger insert holes, looked at his phone.¹¹⁵ He drove to Leo's, set up, played a very fun set with Steve, Kevin, Evan, took a break, added Scott, Dulci, Becca to the mix, socialized.

He kissed Hannah goodbye, had a hang with the rest of the crew + Leann, ate some deviled eggs, grabbed Jersey Mike's, drove to Meyers, found the larger holes on his new print didn't make a difference.⁷²³ Hannah came over, cuddled a bit, went home. Ross fell asleep.

ix.viii

Ross woke to a 9:15 alarm, did some printing, walked to the market, bought a sammich, coffee, water, sat at 12 Baskets, opened up Morgan's Comics, had a very slow morning, got a coffee visit from Hannah, had things pick up a bit. He closed up, walked to Meyers, made noodles, did more printing, talked to Hannah, mostly laid in bed, looked at his phone, had to pee a lot.⁹⁵⁰

ix.ix

Ross woke early again, tested his no-fillet Rebound left-half print, started a right half, departed the house on foot, was intrigued by a sign for all-day coffee at Weirido Central, had an excellent pour-over, told Hannah to come, had a nice sit on the couch with her and a German Shepard puppy, kissed goodbye.

Ross walked downtown to the bank, deposited \$200 in cash from Trailside Brewing, went to S&W ordered a Walrus Dog, ate in the park, walked to the Greagle, had a pee, sat at the traffic-circle bus stop, walked to Morgan's comics, bought some plastic glue, talked to Bird, walked to Meyers,¹⁴⁵ drove to Best Buy, bought two packs of filament when one would have sufficed, back to Meyers.²⁴¹

Ross laid in bed, looked at his phone, talked to Hannah, walked to Downing, chatted with Charlie, who was picking up money. He walked with an overwhelmed Hannah to Taco Billy, ordered two Little Sisters, took Hannah to class at Story Parlor, kissed her goodbye, walked to Meyers, printed green top-sides for Rebound, laid in bed a while, looked at his phone, took a stab at making the port hole taller in OnShape.⁸⁴⁶

He picked Hannah up from class, dropped her at Downing, kissed her goodnight, went to Meyers, looked at his phone, slept.

ix.x

Ross woke earliesh, assembled his green Rebound and was happy with it. He made coffee when Stephen got up, had him unlock the basement, started laundry, drank coffee in the back yard. He dreamed up a super-simple wedge for adding typing angle to the Rebound case, designed that, sent it to the printer, changed over laundry, redid the design, folded clothes, printed a second wedge, drank more coffee, did some typing, made noodles, ate in the back garden, brewed a fourth cup.²³²

Ross walked to Odd's, ordered a free latte, continued down to Downing, arriving at the same time as Thomas Kozak. They chatted about silly things, met up with Hannah, loaded the PA into his car. Hannah and Ross got into the Space Bug, drove to Weaverville. Hannah went to meet Jane Kramer at the pizza place while Ross went to a brewery, ate a Cuban w/ tots & Coke.

He walked to Leveller, chatted with Elizabeth Mcorvey, watched a fun night of intimate performances, drove to West Asheville. They went to Ingles, where he bought grape juice. Hannah drove them to Meyers, kissed in the street. Ross went inside, moved the outer screw holes for Rebound 12mm inward, sent the topsides to the printer.⁹⁵⁴

He took a bath, washed his hair, shaved his face, redesigned the left side, sent it to the printer, looked at his phone in bed for a couple hours, redesigned the right side, assembled the right side, sent the left side to the printer, turned out the lights.¹¹¹

ix.xi

Ross woke early, assembled another Rebound prototype, enjoyed the new wedge placement, walked to the market, bought a sammich/coffee/water, went to 12 Baskets, finished his coffee, talked to Lynn, got another. He went into work, squatted in indie

bins all day, helped Bird set up for Pokemon Night, ducked out an hour early, walked with busted legs to Odd's, got a free coffee, sat on the back porch, drank, walked to Middlemont, sat in the front yard for half an hour.

He had a productive rehearsal with Hannah, Ryan, Melissa, ate rice/muscadines/scuppernogs, got in the Space Bug, went to El Paraiso, watched the end of Terminator 5 and the start of 6, ate enchiladas with Hannah, rode to Downing, looked for a new episode of Bake Off a day early. They looked at their phones instead, made the bed, lay in it.

ix.xii

Ross woke bleary eyed, cuddled with Hannah, looked at the Shakori Hills brochure, walked to Bad Manners, ordered a drip, drank some out front, walked to Meyers, opened a package from Keebio, designed the MulletFoot wedge (Shroomie in the front, SKUF in the back,) printed it, enjoyed it, started another with a slightly larger Shroomie hole.¹¹⁴¹

Ross worked on keyboard stuff til 330, got picked up by Hannah, drove the Space Bug to exit 105, ordered Starbucks, continued on to exit 80, went to the Bourland castle, had dinner with Emmylou, Sarah, Dan, Beth, were joined by Peter. They watched an episode of Bakeoff, went to bed.

ix.xiii

Ross and Hannah woke to toddler sounds, ate pancakes, went to Tanglewood, met horses, looked for Fernie the cat, went to the playground, sat in the hot sun, rode back to the castle, ate sandwiches with Weatherly and Susan. Ross hung by the pool while Hannah took a nap; he had had his immediately after breakfast. Yet, he fell asleep on the glider outside nonetheless.

They eventually ate a dinner of steak, polenta, vegetables, watched *Thursday Murder Club*, went to bed.

ix.xiv

The gang woke, ate cinnamon rolls + egg cassarole, went back to Tanglewood, played at both playgrounds, pet some horses, went back to the castle, packed up, hung in the front yard, departed. Ross and Hannah stopped at exit 125, got coffee; Ross took over driving, drove himself to Meyers, laid in bed, started a long print, ordered pizza, drove to Lanvale, picked up his Venmo card, drove to Dominos, back to Meyers.

He ate on the couch, did printing and laying in bed, eventually getting the wedges for Rebound dialed in. He tightened down screws, wrote in his journal, felt pleased with the experience.¹²³⁷

ix.xv

Ross woke early, did Wordle, fell back asleep, woke again around 10. He started what he hoped to be his final Rebound print, walked to Rowan, ordered a pourover, perused VHS at Orbit, went back to Meyers, took a bath, shaved, laid in bed, assembled his print, realized he had made frustrating error. He laid in bed some more, talked to Hannah, enjoyed a rain storm, turned on the coffee maker.⁴⁵²

He hopped in the Space Bug around 530, drove to Cherokee, parked in a very wobbly garage, checked in at the front desk. The lady gave Hannah and Ross room keys but said they were in the wrong building for the conference, so they went back to the car, drove down the street to a less scary garage, parked, found the conference, eventually found the elevators to their tower, went up to the 7th floor, investigated the room.

They headed towards the casino, ate at Wicked Weed's smoke house, seemed to be enjoyed by their

waiter. Hannah pointed out that Ross' neighbor Amy was basically running the conference, and, as they stood up to leave the restaurant, they noticed Amy was doing the same.

"Howdy neighbor," he said. Amy/Hannah introduced themselves and they all walked to the bowling alley, enjoyed courtesy game cards with an hour's worth of time. They played Space Invaders, that updated Frogger game, a baseball game, Mario Kart, a motorcycle game, free food, a basketball game, a round of air hockey, took a walk through the casino floor. They bought a drink from Gordon Ramsay's food court, walked back to the hotel, made love, went to sleep.

ix.xvi

Hannah woke at seven, went to the conference. Ross slept til 10, when he woke in a panic because his phone was dead. He hadn't missed anything, though, stayed in bed for two more hours. He went to Starbucks, met Hannah at the conference, grabbed a plate of food, went to the pool, ate.

They went to the car with a hand cart, transported cornhole boards back to the pool area, a box of candy to the room, decided to head back to West Asheville. They got more coffee, got in the Space Bug. Ross drove himself to Meyers, taking the scenic route through Malvern Hills.³²⁶

He printed for a while, laid in bed, eventually packed his things, drove to Cookout, ordered a nearly-\$10 tray, continued to Downing, set up the iMac at the white desk. He fiddled with trying to install Linux on his Chromebook, but mainly focused on designing the Tuxedo (or Tux) PCB, which he had mostly finished by 1AM.

ix.xvii

Ross woke around 10, charged his phone, walked to Bad Manners, drank a murder water/drip out front, continued to Izzy's, where he ordered another coffee, sat outside. He walked down to Middlemont, had a semi-productive rehearsal with Tina, Ryan, Melissa, Max, packed up the drums, walked hungrily to UJ, ordered a brisket wrap/tots/Coke, chatted with Angus about Dr. Dog/life.

He paid, walked across the street to the Brew Pump, drank an Athletic, said what's up to Michel. Drunk Rob came outside, declared how long it had been since he's seen Ross, told him his leather journal was filled up with sketches. Ross walked to Downing, redid some things on the Tux PCB, started on the case, got a visit from Meliss/Max, who had borrowed the PA.

They brought that into the house and Melissa convinced Ross to accompany them to Highland for Amanda's birthday party, where good music was being played. He drank a couple Athletica, chatted with Evan, Leah, Kevin, Kevin, Amanda, etc., got back in the black Element, rode to Downing, worked on the Tux case, felt satisfied, posted pictures into Hazel's shitposting, chatted briefly with tipsy Hannah, went to bed.

ix.xviii

Ross woke, tired, drank grape juice, charged his phone, did a couple dishes, cleaned litter boxes, made a generic bottom for Tux, put it into Onshape, turned off his computer, put it in the Camry, packed the rest of his things, sat on the couch and waited for Hannah to arrive. He gave her kisses, then Turtlecat.

He drove to Hillcrest, brought in his blanket, cuddled on the couch with Myrtle, made coffee, drank two cups while watching videos, brought in his

computer/laundry basket, opened his journal, wrote, pooped.¹³²

He restarted the Tux case, had a slow day with lots of video watching. He didn't get very productive until late at night.

ix.xix

Ross woke, made coffee, restarted Tux again, had a very productive day. A storm rolled in around seven, which he watched, failing to realize at first that the power had been knocked out. He talked to Hannah and they canceled their plans to hang out.

ix.xx

Ross woke, still to no power, realized the line was down. He drove to Rite Rite, charged his phone a bit, went to the Hot Spot, bought a charger, filled up the Camry, drove to Atlanta, stopping once at Chick-Fil-A.

He greeted Tina, loaded in, set up, greeted Ryan, Melissa, Bellah, played a tiny show, packed up, loaded out, said goodbye to the Hymanbergs, followed Tina to Chris' house in the woods, ate cheese, felt a bit bored, went to bed.

ix.xxi

Ross woke, ate early breakfast, still bored by his hosts. He drove to a Starbucks, then Travis' house, grabbed a new Fossil PCB, showed off his Rebound case, chatted in the driveway, drove to Meyers, laid in bed for 10 minutes, got picked up by Hannah/Kathryn, rode to Aldi, watched them shop.

He went to Jersey Mike's, walked to the Odd, ate, re-met Hannah at Firestorm. Rachel's husband Lior was going to give a talk but didn't. They rode to Middlemont, hung out with lots of folks for Max's second birthday, went to Downing, laid in bed. Hannah listed her fears anxieties, then gave a mach

presentation of her final creative facilitation project for Karek Turr and Adam. They watched Bakeoff, soon went to bed.

ix.xxii

Ross woke to cuddles from a silly monkey, made it coffee, kissed it goodbye, walked to the weird coffee shop, laid on a couch next to the sleeping dude with the dog, drank a pour over, walked downtown, chatted with Cliff, went to the bank, deposited \$150 from the Atlanta show, went to Wasabi, ate Udon, went to High Five, ordered a drip, drank it in the park.

He walked west, stopped at the Greagle, looked at his phone, peed, went to Battle Cat, drank an espresso, showed off an acorn he had found, stopped by Country Club, had an Athletic, went to Ingles, bough floss, grape juice, peas, went to Meyers, put his groceries away, pooped, flossed, brushed, set up his computer, looked at his phone, broke his streak, wrote in his journal.⁵³⁹

He opened the Tabby Onshape file, realized it was a mess, went back to KiCad, printed a top in grey, talked to Hannah took a bath, shaved, made noodles, ate, realized the holes were too small, made another, talked to Hannah, plugged in the label printer.¹¹⁰⁸

ix.xxiii

Ross woke around eight, played Wordle, designed a bottom plate for Tabby, sent it to the printer, went back to bed until noon. He realized the design would need supports, reprinted, walked to Rowan, ordered a pour over, felt guilty about drinking it, walked to the market, ordered a burrito, continued to Meyers, verified his print, removed the supports, started another, ate his burrito, did the dishes, tried to tidy the top of his dresser, accomplished very little, closed applications for a reboot.²²⁰